

FILE MANAGEMENT AND CATALOGING

Almost everyone these days has a lot of hard drive space and needless to say, most of that is filled up with an ump-teen number of various files. There might be personal images & videos, work stuff, music and other forms of entertainment. All this over time tends to pile up and then one fine day your hard drive is totally full and you have no more space for new stuff. Here is a bunch of things you can do to help you get rid of the clutter once and for all.

Will power & hoarding

All of us have the compulsion to collect stuff that we like, however, sometimes these things tend to exceed their true value. There have been incidents of people collecting LOLCATS, when all they have to do is visit one of the numerous websites and have your fill. Well, hoarding is bad and you need to gather all your will power and go through the remaining steps. Believe us, it'll help you out!

Arm yourself

There are multiple tools available on the Internet for managing files and while they each may offer some unique function, you need not go after everyone of them, remember what we talked about hoarding? You'll need one tool to defragment your drive, one to help speed up all the operations that you'll be performing manually. One such tool is 'FileMenu'. One way to describe this tool would be an amalgamation of various context menu registry hacks. It even has a browser window open up for copy/move options so you don't have to move away from the window you are currently working on.



Stop hoarding!

Dump it all in one place

When you have a lot of files, there are bound to be a few files which you don't know what to do with. So when you come across a file which you can't assign into a category, you simply put the file into a dump folder. Soon enough this folder will be full off files pertaining to all sorts of media. Delete everything that is of no use.

Defragment your drive

Some of the steps that are about to follow requires software to go though your hard drive one file at a time so defragmenting all the drives you have would speed up all the remaining steps. Before you go about defragmenting the hard drive, run any clean up software to get rid of temporary files. Use any software for the purpose, Ccleaner should get the job done. Then for defragmenting the drive, one can use Defraggler which is donationware and is pretty good at getting the job done. If you prefer to use the in-built disk defragmenting software then you can do so.

Get rid of dupes

Duplicate files eat up valuable hard drive space and should be taken care of at the earliest. Doublekiller is one pretty neat software to get the job done. It allows you to find duplicates using

multiple criteria. Duplicate files can be listed if their CRC32 hash, name, size and/or date of creation are the same. You may choose to skip one or two criteria to suit your needs. Be careful while using the software though, you may end up losing valuable files if you do not pay attention. While we were checking the software out, Doublekiller ended up picking the licensing files from one of our computers, deleting which would have left all the software useless. So pay attention while deleting the duplicates. Only include the folders which you are sure about, try to exclude the 'Program Files' directory altogether. Click on 'Check the last dupes' under the Doublekiller tab and delete all the checked files. An alternative is Auslogics Duplicate File Finder, however, it does not have all the options that Doublekiller offers for you to fiddle with. Now that you've gotten rid of the dupes, let's move onto organising your stuff.

Assign default directories

Download managers have the option of allocating files into specific folders depending upon the file type. Internet Download Manager (IDM) for example, provides for different folders for different file types. Make

use of such features to have your files put into their respective folders. If you have a folder for music then set the default directory for music files to that particular folder in IDM and so on for every file type.

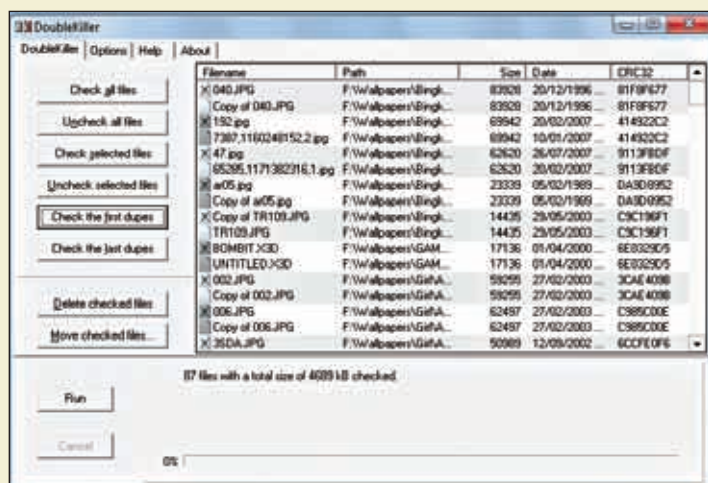
You may change the default directory for My Documents to another partition on the hard drive entirely, this will help you to maintain consistency over multiple OS installations on the same computer. You can do this by right-clicking on the My documents, select 'Properties' and then modify the 'Target folder location'. For linux, the steps may vary in different distributions. Here, we are listing the steps for Ubuntu.

Ensure NTFS partitions can be accessed in Ubuntu, for that to happen type in the following commands in the terminal. (Open a terminal window using Ctrl+Alt+T)

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sudo apt-get install ntfs-config
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Accept all the prompts, then type, gksu ntfs-config
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This should automatically configure all the NTFS partitions to be mounted in Ubuntu. Once this is done, you'll need to edit the file system table file, i.e. 'fstab' file to create an auto mount entry for your Documents folder. The syntax of an fstab entry is :



Use Doublekiller to get rid of the duplicates